Practical - 7

Practical Title: PHP Form Processing with Server-Side Validation and CSV/JSON File Storage

Problem Definition: Process submitted registration/contact form data using PHP. Validate and sanitize inputs on the server, handle file writing safely into CSV/JSON format, and display clear success/error messages.

A. Theory & Analysis

1. Is the form submitted using POST?

Yes. Form data is submitted using the HTTP POST method (<form method='POST' action='../php/contact.php'>). The POST method sends data within the HTTP request body rather than visible URL query parameters, protecting user entries from appearing in browser histories.

2. Are inputs validated and sanitized server side?

Yes. The PHP script retrieves fields via $_POST and applies server validation: trim() removes extra whitespace, htmlspecialchars(..., ENT_QUOTES, 'UTF-8') neutralizes special characters to prevent Cross-Site Scripting (XSS), and filter_var($email, FILTER_VALIDATE_EMAIL) checks that the email format is valid.

3. Is file writing handled safely?

Yes. The script opens the file in append mode (fopen($file, 'a')). If the file is new or empty, header columns are written first. Data rows are appended using fputcsv($handle, $data) with standard delimiters and enclosures. Potential spreadsheet formula injection is mitigated by sanitizing text inputs.

4. Are success and error responses displayed clearly?

Yes. If validation passes, a green Bootstrap alert confirms the submission details. If any field is missing or invalid, a red alert lists the specific validation errors with a link to return to the form.

B. Implementation Details

I developed the contact support processor in php/contact.php to receive submissions from pages/contact.html. Inputs undergo server-side sanitization and validation before being appended to storage/contacts.csv. I verified that new inquiries correctly append rows to the CSV file with submitted timestamps.

C. Evidence of Work

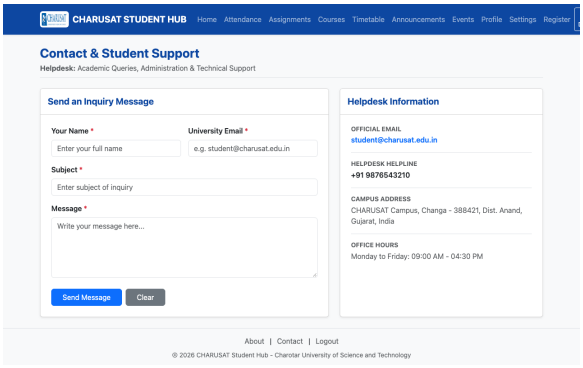


Fig 1: Contact Support Form with Name, Email, Subject, and Message Fields

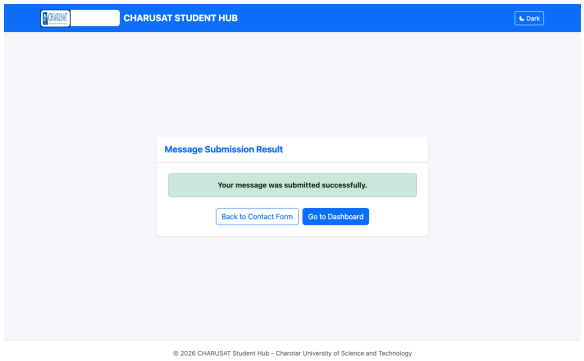


Fig 2: Server-Side PHP Success Response Confirming CSV Record Storage



Figure 3: Persistent Storage File (storage/contacts.csv) Showing Appended Data Records

D. Repository Link

GitHub Repository: https://github.com/neel92654/WDF_A_ARP

E. Learning Outcomes

I learned how to process HTTP POST form data in PHP, implement server-side validation and sanitization against XSS, and safely append structured records to persistent CSV files.